

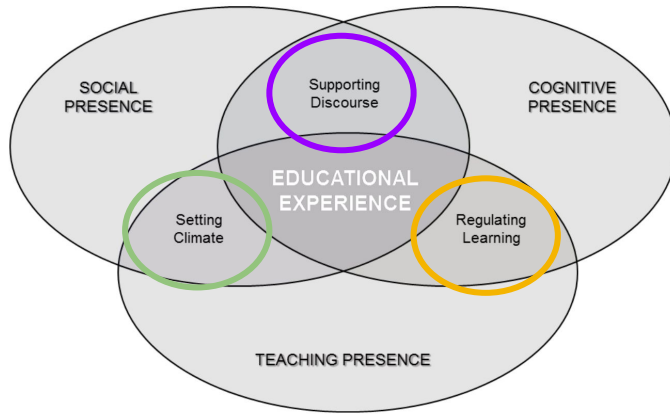
From Presences to Linked Influences within Communities of Inquiry

Discussion Forums Subteam

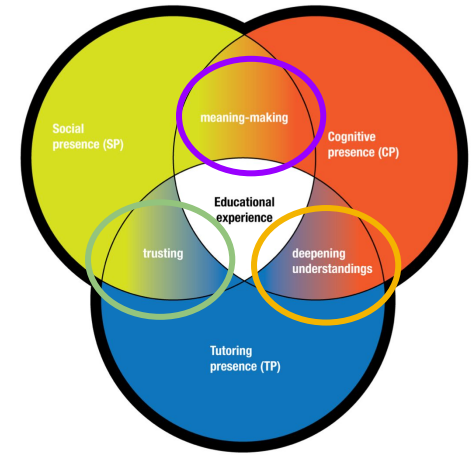
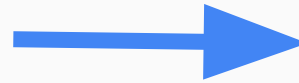


Overview of the Article

- The goal of the article was to shift our understanding of the Community of Inquiry Framework (CoIF) from an emphasis on Presences (Social, Cognitive, and Tutorial) to an emphasis on Influences (combinations of two presences)

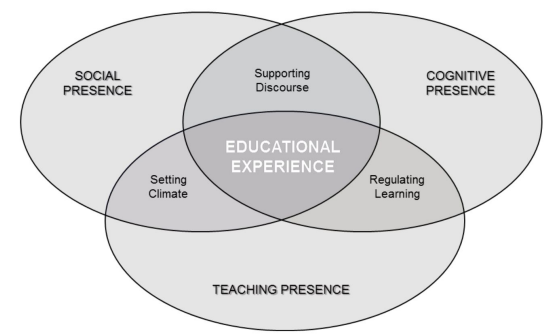


Garrison (2011)



Peacock & Cowan (2016)

Summary of relevant literature



Article often references and enhances Dr. Garrison's model that establishes the three Presences in detail.

Social Presence

- Engagement of everyone in the Col
- Purposeful communication
- Develop sense of belonging to group and academic goals

Teaching Presence

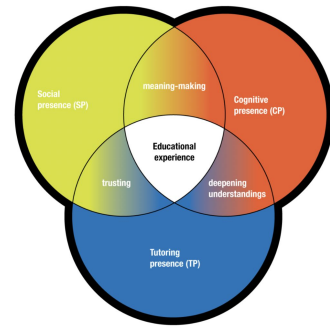
- includes "the design and facilitation of social and cognitive presence in a community of inquiry."
- Lipman (2003): teacher

Cognitive Presence

- Critical thinking
- Reasoning
- Evaluation
- Judgement
- How do members of the community make meaning from the dialogue/discussion?

→ Tutoring Presence

Research Methods



Research design: Studied student-managed learning activities supported by tutoring and facilitation and considered the interweaving of the Presences in pairs (Influences)

Participants: learners and facilitative tutors

- **Trusting:** tutors set the tone of openness, fairness, safety, and debate; nurture self-efficacy to lead individuals and communities to go beyond their expectations; prepare learners to cope with emotional issues
- **Meaning-Making:** clear facilitative prompting by tutors to promote cognition, metacognition; encourage questioning of peers and defense of others' ideas
- **Deepening Understandings:** tutors initiate searching and engagement with potentially useful cognitive content; start and sustain critical discourse

Research Data



Data (collection) and analyses:

- **Trusting:** learners felt more safe and comfortable in dialogic debates and open exchanges; developed a trusting sense of belonging with their online discussion group; developed coping mechanisms
- **Meaning-Making:** learners worked together interdependently while asking challenging questions; jointly managed opportunities for, and impediments to, cognition; reviewed progress to date and set appropriate goals accordingly
- **Deepening Understandings:** learners monitored and regulated their learning; engaged in critical thinking, creativity, and problem-solving; deepened accumulating understandings and developed evidence-based reasoning with emerging concepts

Results and Discussion

The presences seem more meaningful and influential for learning when they are interlinked strategically, especially in online learning

Learner and Tutor Benefits of the Influences

- (SP/CP) Improve learners' understandings of, and skills in, social communications
- (TP/SP) Encourage the group and individuals to engage trustingly in their self-regulatory and metacognitive activities, including the management of their particular emotional responses to collaborative learning
- (CP/TP) Tutors can inform the development of cognitive maps

Q1: How can the results of this study impact online courses in the future?

- The use of “cognitive maps” that allow learners to track and plan their own progress
- More discussion/questions of each other’s ideas
 - “Prompt responses that acknowledge and encourage”
- Group projects graded on individual’s work
- Better relationship between learners despite being online

Tutors

- Aid emotional issues that arise with online learning
- Changing outlook from individuals to groups in the courses
- Nurture learner’s skills to allow greater collaboration
- Encourage familiarity with online discussions

Q2: What are the strengths and weaknesses of this study? Think of the study design, appropriateness of analysis methods, populations and sample size, selected courses, data gathering, comprehensiveness, etc.

- Strength :

Well-structured, connected to their claims with experiences

- Weakness :

Used authors' experiences to support their claims

Better to use numerical data

Q3: How can you extend this study to validate the conclusions or make a more general conclusion?

- Each of the influences must be explored in-depth to understand their roles and impact in a learning community and to confirm the advantages of adding influences to the COI framework.
- Experimental studies allow us to compare existing and improved COIFs to determine whether the improved framework is more appropriate for conclusions.
- The influences-based framework should be implemented in learning community and measurements such as surveys should be used to confirm the proposed benefits of this enhanced framework.